
SPIRE
Symposium

AND

*Departmental Honors
Presentations*

**MONDAY, APRIL 21, 2025
9 A.M.-6:30 P.M.**







DEPARTMENTAL HONORS

THE CHRISTINE P. TISCHER SCHOLARS

Dominic Bechtel

Riana Caldwell

Rebecca Carroll

Casey Chamberlin

Sophia DeGennaro

Maddy Dillon

Sophia Isabel Ferrer

Phebe Frost

Meray Ghobrial

Anne Hudson

Austin Kaplan

Melissa Nunez

Grey Phillips

Elizabeth Porter

Maxamillian Rajaobelina-Phipps

Remi Schaber

Katherine "Katie" Stang

Katelyn Svitak

Olivia Todd



SCHEDULE

SPIRE SYMPOSIUM: UNDERGRADUATE STUDENT, FACULTY AND STAFF PRESENTATIONS

POSTER PRESENTATIONS AND ARTWORK: SESSION I 9-10 A.M.

Whitaker Campus Center

ORAL PRESENTATIONS: SESSION I 10:10-10:55 A.M.

Beneficial-Hodson Library and
Learning Commons

ORAL PRESENTATIONS: SESSION II 11-11:45 A.M.

Beneficial-Hodson Library and
Learning Commons

ORAL PRESENTATIONS: SESSION III

11:50 A.M.-12:35 P.M.

Beneficial-Hodson Library and
Learning Commons

POSTER PRESENTATIONS AND ARTWORK: SESSION II 1:15-2:15 P.M.

Whitaker Campus Center

DEPARTMENTAL HONORS

PRESENTATIONS: SESSION I 2:30-3:15 P.M.

Rosenstock Hall

RECEPTION 4:30 P.M.

Whitaker Campus Center, Commons

PRESENTATIONS: SESSION II 3:20-4:15 P.M.

Rosenstock Hall



SCHEDULE

SPIRE SYMPOSIUM: GRADUATE STUDENT, FACULTY AND STAFF PRESENTATIONS

ORAL PRESENTATIONS

5:30-6:30 P.M.

Hodson Science and Technology Center

POSTER PRESENTATIONS

5:30-6:30 P.M.

Whitaker Campus Center

A NOTE OF GRATITUDE

It took a large team of people to ensure such an exciting and successful day of scholarship. We would like to thank the committee members of SPIRE, SAFIRE and Tischer Scholars for planning and coordinating the day's events. Special thanks go to President Debbie Ricker, Ph.D., Provost Paige Eager, Ph.D., and Associate Provost and Dean of the Graduate School April Boulton, Ph.D., for all the support they provided throughout the year. We would also like to thank Bonnie Kern, Jim Haines, Toby Peterson and the library staff, the Office of Marketing and Communications, Print and Mail Services, and the Career Center. Finally, we would like to thank the SPIRE Symposium judges and session moderators as well as the faculty and staff mentors who have played a crucial role in preparing students for this day.

SPIRE SYMPOSIUM: UNDERGRADUATE STUDENT, FACULTY AND STAFF PRESENTATIONS

POSTER PRESENTATIONS: SESSION I 9-10 A.M.

WHITAKER CAMPUS CENTER, COMMONS

KAITLIN BECKFORD

THE ROLE OF MIR-19A IN
BREAST CANCER METASTASIS

Department of Biology

Adviser: Meredith Yeager, Ph.D.

TAMARA STANFORD

MLPH GENE IMPACT ON
FELINE COAT COLOR

Department of Biology

Adviser: Meredith Yeager, Ph.D.

MELISSA NUNEZ

THIOPHENE
HYDRODESULFURIZATION ON
HIGH-CAPACITY MESOPOROUS
PEROVSKITE OXIDE CATALYSTS

Department of Chemistry and Physics

Adviser: Ashish Chakradhar, Ph.D.

MATTHEW SMITH

HANDWRITTEN
ALPHANUMERIC CHARACTER
RECOGNITION WITH DEEP
NEURAL NETWORKS USING
THE EXTENDED MNIST DATA
SET

Department of Computer Science and
Information Technology

Adviser: Jiang Li, Ph.D.

LILIAN WOLF AND EMMA MCGRAW

A HOMEMADE CALORIMETER:
HOW ACCURATELY DOES IT
MEASURE CALORIC CONTENT

Department of Nursing

Adviser: Ashish Chakradhar, Ph.D.

KIMBERLY LOPEZ ALONZO, CHRISTIANA HESTER AND DOMINIC BECHTEL

THE EFFECTS OF LAVENDER
ON STRESS LEVELS BEFORE
AND AFTER A STRESSFUL TASK

Department of Psychology and
Counseling

Adviser: Sangeeta Gupta, Ph.D.

POSTER PRESENTATIONS: SESSION I

9-10 A.M.

WHITAKER CAMPUS CENTER, COMMONS

ALYSSA MURTAUGH AND KSENYA SWINTON

**EFFECTS OF SMARTPHONE
NOTIFICATIONS ON ATTENTION
AND UNDERSTANDING**

Department of Psychology and
Counseling

Adviser: Sangeeta Gupta, Ph.D.

ELENA DELLA MEA

**HOOD COLLEGE FOOD
INSECURITY: AN EVALUATION
OF THE CAMPUS CUPBOARD**

Department of Nursing

Adviser: Dr. Jacqueline Douge

MELODY PAR

**EVALUATION OF ALCOHOL
PROGRAM: THE HOOD
COLLEGE WELLNESS CENTER**

Department of Nursing

Adviser: Dr. Jacqueline Douge

MIN SHAIN

**PROGRAM EVALUATION ON
RABIES PREVENTION IN
FREDERICK COUNTY**

Department of Nursing

Adviser: Dr. Jacqueline Douge

KINGSLY MANTE ANGUA

**PROGRAM EVALUATION
ON PERIOD POVERTY FOR
YOUTH EXPERIENCING
HOMELESSNESS IN FREDRICK
COUNTY**

Department of Nursing

Adviser: Dr. Jacqueline Douge

DARLIE CALIXTE

FINANCIAL STRESS SURVEY

Department of Sociology and Social
Work

Adviser: Jolene Sanders, Ph.D.

TAJ WEEMS

**FRATERNITY EFFECT ON
MENTAL HEALTH**

Department of Sociology and Social
Work

Adviser: Jolene Sanders, Ph.D.

ERICA CORRELL

**VALORIZATION OF SOYBEAN
WASTE FOR LACTIC ACID**

Department of Biology

Adviser: Daewhan Kim, Ph.D.

MARY ATWELL

**BETA TESTING PROJECT
ODYSSEY: AI METADATA
CREATION**

Hood College Archives

POSTER PRESENTATIONS: SESSION I 9-10 A.M.

WHITAKER CAMPUS CENTER, COMMONS

CHRISTOPHER STROMBERG, PH.D.

HEAVY METAL
CONCENTRATIONS IN
SOILS: A COURSE-BASED
UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH
EXPERIENCE

Department of Chemistry and Physics

JESSICA HAMMACK AND KELLY ESPOSITO

THE CTL AT THE END OF
THE WORLD: A RELATIONAL
APPROACH TO EDUCATIONAL
DEVELOPMENT IN UNCERTAIN
TIMES

Center for Teaching and Learning

NISHA MANIKOTH, PH.D., ANITA JOSE, PH.D., JENNIFER CUDDAPAH, PH.D., AND SONIA BOWIE

SCHOLAR-PRACTITIONER
TRANSFORMATION:
PREPARING MINDFUL
LEADERS IN HOOD'S
DOCTORAL PROGRAM

Doctoral Program

The George B. Delaplaine Jr. School of
Business

ORAL PRESENTATIONS: SESSION I
10:10-10:55 A.M.

BENEFICIAL-HODSON LIBRARY AND LEARNING COMMONS

ROOM 1026 (TUTORING CENTER)

NINA GODDYN

IMPACT OF CLIMATE
CHANGE ON AGRICULTURAL
PRODUCTIVITY: A
COMPARATIVE STUDY OF
DEVELOPED AND DEVELOPING
COUNTRIES

The George B. Delaplaine Jr. School of
Business

Adviser: Janak Joshi, Ph.D.

SARA MUNSON

MODELING THE GAME OF
SOFTBALL WITH EXCEL

Department of Mathematics

Adviser: Ann Stewart, Ph.D.

ROOM 2006 (BOARDROOM)

**SHERITA HENRY, DPH, AND
DR. JACQUELINE DOUGE**

POWER, PERCEPTIONS AND
PRESENCE OF BLACK MAMAS
IN MATERNAL HEALTH

Department of Nursing

JENNIFER ROSS, PH.D.

CLIMATE CHANGE IN
ANTIQUITY: STUDIES AT A
TURKISH SITE

Department of Art and Archaeology

ORAL PRESENTATIONS: SESSION I

10:10-10:55 A.M.

BENEFICIAL-HODSON LIBRARY AND LEARNING COMMONS

ROOM 2028

JOSELINE MORAN

**CROSS-CULTURAL MENTAL
HEALTH: TREATMENT, SOCIAL
VIEWS AND EDUCATION IN
AMERICA VS. LATIN AMERICA**

Department of Psychology and
Counseling

Adviser: Sangeeta Gupta, Ph.D.

MADISON SHEFFIELD AND HANNAH POOLE

**MANIPULATIVES IN EARLY
CHILDHOOD**

Department of Education

Adviser: Christy Graybeal, Ph.D.

GABRIELLE AVERILL AND AUGUSTA PINSON

**CRA-I: A MULTI-SENSORY
APPROACH TO MATH
INSTRUCTION**

Department of Education

Adviser: Christy Graybeal, Ph.D.

ORAL PRESENTATIONS: SESSION II

11-11:45 A.M.

BENEFICIAL-HODSON LIBRARY AND LEARNING COMMONS

ROOM 1026 (TUTORING CENTER)

TIMOTHY P. COFFIN, PH.D.

AI-BASES HOSPITAL ASSET
STEWARDSHIP PROGRAM

The Ruth Whitaker Holmes School of
Behavioral and Health Sciences

ROOM 2028

AMANDA AMBROSE AND JOSEPHINE SASSE

HARVESTING MICROALGAE
USING MAGNETOTACTIC
BACTERIA

Department of Biology
Adviser: Craig Laufer, Ph.D.

ETHAN FIRESIDE AND CASEY CHAMBERLIN

DEVIANT MINDS:
UNDERSTANDING
PSYCHOPATHS AND SERIAL
KILLERS

Department of Psychology and
Counseling
Adviser: Jessica McManus, Ph.D.

ROOM 2006 (BOARDROOM)

ISABELLA DIPIETRANTONIO, COLE TATE AND SAMANTHA MIRANDA

THE TRANSFORMATIVE
EXPERIENCE OF STUDY
ABROAD

Study Abroad Office
Adviser: Scott Pincikowski, Ph.D.

ORAL PRESENTATIONS: SESSION III

11:50 A.M.-12:35 P.M.

BENEFICIAL-HODSON LIBRARY AND LEARNING COMMONS

ROOM 1026 (TUTORING CENTER)

SHILOH RAMOS

HIV THE 40+ YEAR GLOBAL
PANDEMIC: A PHOTOVOICE
REVIEW

Department of Nursing

Adviser: Sherita Henry, DPH

IAN SALAKA

HAVE IMF AND WORLD BANK
LOANS STIMULATED POSITIVE
GROWTH IN AFRICAN
ECONOMIES?

The George B. Delaplaine Jr. School of
Business

ROOM 2006 (BOARDROOM)

MAGGIE GRIJALVA, EMMA HOWARD, JASON JOHNSON AND LAUREN NOBLE

ANALYZING MEDIA MESSAGES

First-Year Seminar

Adviser: Rebecca Grove, Ph.D.

ROOM 2028

ALYSSA BYERS

DIONYSUS AS A GOD OF
REBIRTH

Department of Art and Archaeology

Adviser: Jennifer Ross, Ph.D.

SUSAN BOROSKIN

A TRIBUTE TO LIVES LOST

Department of Music

Adviser: Shannon Kunday, Ph.D.

KAITLIN BECKFORD

UNEARTHED HISTORY:
THE DISPLACEMENT OF
GREENMOUNT CEMETERY IN
FREDERICK, MARYLAND

Honors Program

Adviser: Robert Casas, Ph.D.

POSTER PRESENTATIONS: SESSION II

1:15-2:15 P.M.

WHITAKER CAMPUS CENTER, COMMONS

AUSTIN KAPLAN

THE IMPACT OF RAINBOW
DARTERS ON THE
MICROHABITAT USE OF OTHER
DARTER SPECIES

Department of Biology
Adviser: Eric Kindahl, Ph.D.

KENDALL ELENBASS

ANALYZING THE GAP ACTIVITY
OF NEUROFIBROMIN MUTANTS

Department of Biology
Adviser: Dom Esposito, Ph.D.

COLIN FLANAGAN

INVESTIGATING THE
RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN
POLYMER INK SOLUTIONS
AND THEIR WETTABILITY
VIA HIGH THROUGHPUT
EXPERIMENTATION AND
MACHINE LEARNING

Department of Chemistry and Physics
Adviser: Christopher
Stromberg, Ph.D.

SPENCER CRISCUOLI, HAIDEN NAILL, LEULE YOHANNES AND DIANA MONDRAGON

AWE AND HUMILITY: A
REPLICATION STUDY

Department of Psychology and
Counseling
Adviser: Sangeeta Gupta, Ph.D.

SUSAN BOROSKIN, SUMMER GROVE, DANIELLE BRIDGES AND MORRIGAN PETHERICK

THE EMPATHY TASK:
EFFORTFUL OR NOT?

Department of Psychology and
Counseling
Adviser: Sangeeta Gupta, Ph.D.

REGANNE HALEY, JASMINE SADLER, ANALYN WEYANT AND ISABELLA BAUERLEIN

EMOTION REGULATION
BENEFITS ACROSS
SOCIOECONOMIC STATUS: A
REPLICATION STUDY

Department of Psychology and
Counseling
Adviser: Sangeeta Gupta, Ph.D.

ANAYIKA THOMPSON

EXAMINING THE ASSOCIATION
BETWEEN AGE AND SERUM
GLUCOSE LEVELS: A
FRAMINGHAM HEART STUDY
ANALYSIS

Department of Nursing
Adviser: Sherita Henry, DPH

POSTER PRESENTATIONS: SESSION II

1:15-2:15 P.M.

WHITAKER CAMPUS CENTER, COMMONS

BITHSSIE ETIENNE

THE IMPACT OF SMOKING
BEHAVIOR ON THE INCIDENCE
OF CARDIOVASCULAR DISEASE
(CVD) AMONG ADULTS IN THE
FRAMINGHAM HEART STUDY

Department of Nursing

Adviser: Sherita Henry, DPH

ELENA DELLA MEA

BMI AND HYPERTENSION

Department of Nursing

Adviser: Sherita Henry, DPH

MIN SHAIN

DIABETES AND
CARDIOVASCULAR DISEASE

Department of Nursing

Adviser: Sherita Henry, DPH

SHILOH RAMOS

THE INSIDE LOOK OF THE
FRAMINGHAM HEART STUDY
WITH BLOOD PRESSURE

Department of Nursing

Adviser: Sherita Henry, DPH

ISABELLA DIPIETRANTONIO

THINK BEFORE YOU
TRASH: ANALYZING AND
IMPLEMENTING CAMPUS
WASTE REUSE INITIATIVES AT
HOOD COLLEGE

Department of Biology

Advisers: Drew Ferrier, Ph.D., and
Amanda Dymek

JIANG LI, PH.D., JENNIFER CUDDAPAH, PH.D., AND MARISEL TORRES- GRESPO, PH.D.

HOOD'S MCCE COMPUTER
SCIENCE EDUCATION
PROGRAM: ADVANCING
TEACHER EDUCATORS 2.0
THROUGH COMPUTATIONAL
THINKING COURSE
STRATEGIES

Department of Computer Science and
Information Technology

Department of Education

STEVEN CLARK, PH.D.

LIGHT IN THE SHADOWS:
PRIMORDIAL BLACK HOLES
MAKING DARK MATTER SHINE

Department of Chemistry and Physics

SANDRA THOMAS- LALMANSINGH, PH.D.

ESSENTIAL HEALTH
ASSESSMENT SKILLS
FOR PRE-LICENSURE BSN
STUDENTS: PREPARING
FUTURE NURSES FOR
CLINICAL PRACTICE THROUGH
EVIDENCE-BASED TEACHING

The Ruth Whitaker Holmes School of
Behavioral and Health Sciences

DEPARTMENTAL HONORS

PRESENTATIONS: SESSION I 2:30-3:15 P.M.

ROSENSTOCK HALL

ROOM 120 (DATA DRIVEN FREDERICK CENTER)

CASEY CHAMBERLIN

ASSESSING SCHOOL-RELATED
ANXIETY LEVELS AMONG
FIRST-GENERATION COLLEGE
STUDENTS

Department of Psychology and
Counseling

Adviser: Sangeeta Gupta, Ph.D.

Committee: Shannon Kunday, Ph.D.,
and Michelle Gricus, DSW

MADDY DILLON

SEASONAL MENTAL HEALTH
CHANGES IN COLLEGE
ATHLETES

Department of Psychology and
Counseling

Adviser: Stephanie Masters, Ph.D.

Committee: Jessica McManus, Ph.D.,
and Michelle Gricus, DSW

ROOM 123

AUSTIN KAPLAN

THE IMPACT OF RAINBOW
DARTERS ON THE
MICROHABITAT USE OF OTHER
DARTER SPECIES

Department of Biology

Department of Mathematics

Adviser: Eric Kindahl, Ph.D.

Committee: Drew Ferrier, Ph.D., and
James Parson, Ph.D.

ELIZABETH PORTER

CONNECTIONS BETWEEN
GROUP THEORY AND
POLYNOMIAL EQUATIONS: THE
LEGACY OF LAGRANGE

Department of Mathematics

Adviser: James Parson, Ph.D.

Committee: Sarah Malec, Ph.D., and
Jiang Li, Ph.D.

PRESENTATIONS: SESSION I
2:30-3:15 P.M.
ROSENSTOCK HALL

ROOM 123 (CONTINUED)

REMI SCHABER

CAPTURE AND ANNIHILATION
OF DARK MATTER IN WHITE
DWARFS

Department of Mathematics

Advisers: Steven Clark, Ph.D., and Ann
Stewart, Ph.D.

Committee: Steven Clark, Ph.D., and
Ann Stewart, Ph.D.

ROOM 212

REBECCA CARROLL

“UNEASY LIES THE HEAD
THAT WEARS THE CROWN”
— FATHERS AND SONS IN
SHAKESPEARE’S HISTORY
PLAYS

Department of English and
Communication Arts

Adviser: Aaron Angello, Ph.D.

Committee: Heather Mitchell-Buck,
Ph.D., and Noel Verzosa, Ph.D.

SOPHIA DEGENNARO

BROADWAY, THE MEDIA AND
FRAMING THEORY

Department of English and
Communication Arts

Adviser: Elizabeth Atwood, Ph.D.

Committee: Aaron Angello, Ph.D., and
Noel Verzosa, Ph.D.

GREY PHILLIPS

ECHOES IN STARLIGHT:
THE SUN AND MOON IN
MYTHOLOGY

Department of English and
Communication Arts

Adviser: Elizabeth Knapp, Ph.D.

Committee: Amy Gottfried, Ph.D., and
Katie Barnett

PRESENTATIONS: SESSION I
2:30-3:15 P.M.
ROSENSTOCK HALL

ROOM 218

ANNE HUDSON

TO CREATE IS TO KNOW:
AN EXAMINATION OF
EXPERIMENTAL ARCHAEOLOGY
THROUGH RECREATIONS
OF PRECLASSIC MAYA
CHOCOLATE POTS

Department of Art and Archaeology
Adviser: Jennifer Ross, Ph.D.
Committee: David Hixson, Ph.D.,
Kimberly Morse Jones, Ph.D., and
Didier Course, Ph.D.

MAXAMILLIAN

RAJAABELINA-PHIPPS

THE “BLAZING FURNACE”
AND THE “TIGERS AND
FLIES”: AN ANALYSIS OF
THE TOOLS, PATTERNS AND
PROSECUTIONS OF THE XI
JINPING AND NGUYEN PHU
TRONG ANTI-CORRUPTION
CAMPAIGNS

Department of Political Science and
Global Studies
Adviser: Paige Eager, Ph.D.
Committee: Paige Eager, Ph.D.,
Carin Robinson, Ph.D., and
Daniel Cozart, Ph.D.

PRESENTATIONS: SESSION II
3:20-4:15 P.M.
ROSENSTOCK HALL

ROOM 120 (DATA DRIVEN FREDERICK CENTER)

DOMINIC BECHTEL

MUSIC AS MEDICINE: THE
HEALING QUALITY OF MUSIC
THROUGH A HISTORICAL,
CULTURAL AND MODERN LENS

Department of Psychology and
Counseling

Department of Music

Adviser: Noel Verzosa, Ph.D.

Committee: Sangeeta Gupta, Ph.D.,
and Shannon Kunder, Ph.D.

KATELYN SVITAK

PERCEPTIONS OF MENTAL
HEALTH: THE IMPACT OF
MENTAL HEALTH CAMPAIGNS
ON SELF-IDENTIFICATION
WITH MENTAL ILLNESS,
PERCEIVED CONTROL AND
PERCEIVED NEED FOR
PROFESSIONAL TREATMENT

Department of Psychology and
Counseling

Adviser: Jessica McManus, Ph.D.

Committee: Sangeeta Gupta, Ph.D.,
and Catherine Breneman, Ph.D.

ROOM 123

SOPHIA ISABEL FERRER

UTILIZING LATENT SPACE
REPRESENTATION FOR
DISEASE PHENOTYPING AND
PATIENT RISK STRATIFICATION

Department of Computer Science and
Information Technology

Adviser: Aijuan Dong , Ph.D.

Committee: Sara Malec, Ph.D., and
Silvia Crivelli, Ph.D.

MELISSA NUNEZ

THIOPHENE
HYDRODESULFURIZATION ON
HIGH-CAPACITY MESOPOROUS
PEROVSKITE OXIDE CATALYSTS

Department of Chemistry and Physics

Adviser: Ashish Chakradhar, Ph.D.

Committee: Kevin Bennett, Ph.D., and
Sara Malec, Ph.D.

PRESENTATIONS: SESSION II

3:20-4:15 P.M.

ROSENSTOCK HALL

ROOM 212

MERAY GHOBRIAL

GENERATIVE AI AND USER-
GENERATED CONTENT:
INFLUENCES ON BRAND-
CONSUMER RELATIONSHIPS
AND PURCHASE INTENTIONS

Department of English and
Communication Arts

The George B. Delaplaine Jr. School of
Business

Adviser: Brooke Witherow, Ph.D.

Committee: Jessica McManus, Ph.D.,
and Marc Dupont, Ph.D.

PHEBE FROST

(DON'T) EAT YOUR
YOUNG: THE CREATION,
DECONSTRUCTION, AND
RECONSTRUCTION OF
COMMUNITIES, DEVELOPMENT
OF AGENCY, AND MODELING
OF LEARNING BEHAVIORS
IN FOLKLORE, ADAPTATIONS
OF FOLKLORE, AND STORIES
INSPIRED BY FOLKLORE

Adviser: Heather Mitchell-Buck, Ph.D.

Committee: Brooke Witherow, Ph.D.,
and Trevor Dodman, Ph.D.

OLIVIA TODD

THE INFLUENCE OF
PARTY IDEOLOGY ON
TOLERANCE: EXPLORING THE
RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN
POLITICAL IDENTITY
AND EMPATHY TOWARD
IDEOLOGICAL OUTGROUPS

Department of Political Science and
Global Studies

Department of English and
Communication Arts

Adviser: Tamelyn Tucker-Worgs, Ph.D.

Committee: Carin Robinson, Ph.D., and
Alan Goldenbach

PRESENTATIONS: SESSION II

3:20-4:15 P.M.

ROSENSTOCK HALL

ROOM 218

KATHERINE “KATIE” STANG

CHARACTERIZATION OF
PAPILLOMAVIRUS IN AFRICAN
LIONS (PANTHERA LEO): A
LOOK AT THE CONNECTIONS
BETWEEN LIONS AND OTHER
CATS

Department of Biology

Adviser: Meredith Yeager, Ph.D.

Committee: Susan Ensels, Ph.D., and
Cherry Liu, Ph.D.

REBECCA CARROLL

CHARACTERIZATION OF
PAPILLOMAVIRUS IN AFRICAN
LIONS (PANTHERA LEO): A
LOOK AT BOTSWANA

Department of Biology

Adviser: Meredith Yeager, Ph.D.

Committee: Cherry Liu, Ph.D., and
Susan Ensels, Ph.D.

RIANA CALDWELL

CHARACTERIZATION OF
PAPILLOMAVIRUS IN AFRICAN
LIONS (PANTHERA LEO): A
LOOK AT TANZANIA

Department of Biology

Adviser: Meredith Yeager, Ph.D.

Committee: Cherry Liu, Ph.D., and
Susan Ensels, Ph.D.

SPIRE SYMPOSIUM: GRADUATE STUDENT, FACULTY AND STAFF PRESENTATIONS

ORAL PRESENTATIONS 5:30-6:30 P.M.

HODSON SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY CENTER

ROOM 131

DANA EDWARDS

NAVIGATING
MISPERCEPTIONS: HOW
INTERSECTIONALITY SHAPES
THE EXPERIENCES OF BLACK
WOMEN IN EXECUTIVE
LEADERSHIP IN K-12
EDUCATION

Department of Education

Adviser: Jennifer Cuddapah, Ph.D.

LAURIE WARD

"SALT POTATOES"

Department of English and
Communication Arts

Adviser: Elizabeth Knapp, Ph.D.

NICOLE ABUHAMADA

BRUTALISM: A FEMINIST
MEMOIR IN VERSE

Department of English and
Communication Arts

Adviser: Elizabeth Knapp, Ph.D.

PAULA ANSELMO BALLESTER

AN ECOFEMINIST READING
OF EDITH WHARTON'S
SUMMER (1917) AND CATERINA
ALBERT'S SOLITUDE (1905):
TWO EARLY TYPES OF
ECOFEMINISM NOVELS

Humanities (M.A.)

Adviser: Scott Pincikowski, Ph.D.

TAUREAN WASHINGTON

ART-HOP: AN INTRODUCTION

Humanities (M.A.)

Adviser: Kimberly Morse Jones, Ph.D.

POSTER PRESENTATIONS

5:30-6:30 P.M.

WHITAKER CAMPUS CENTER, COMMONS

ALEXEY KRESIN

AI-DRIVEN MARKET REACTION
SIMULATION: PREDICTING
INVESTOR BEHAVIOR FROM
NEWS SENTIMENT

Department of Computer Science and
Information Technology

Adviser: Jiang Li, Ph.D.

ARYANA NIKPORA

INDIGENOUS HEALING
METHODS IN COUNSELING

Department of Psychology and
Counseling

Adviser: Amber Samuels, Ph.D.

KAVITHA FERNANDO

BRIDGING THE GAP:
IDENTIFYING THE NUTRITION
EDUCATION NEEDS OF
COLLEGE STUDENTS

Department of Nursing

Adviser: Joanna Eaton, MSPH, RDN

CHRIS MACDOWELL AND SARAH SETIAWAN

COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS OF
DATA CLEANING ACCURACY:
TRADITIONAL VS. GENERATIVE
AI

Department of Computer Science and
Information Technology

Advisers: Ahmed Salem, Ph.D., and
Carol Jim, Ph.D.

DIANISHA BAXTER CARTER AND ISABELLE OUIMETTE

REDUCING TRAUMATIC
BIRTHS FOR VULNERABLE
POPULATIONS

Department of Psychology and
Counseling

Adviser: Erik Messinger, Ph.D.

GRIFFIN HUNT

THE POWER IN RETELLING
STORIES: FROM THE GARDEN
PARTY TO DEAR MISS
MANSFIELD

Humanities (M.A.)

Adviser: Trevor Dodman, Ph.D.

JASON KENOSKY

OYSTER AQUACULTURE AND
SAV: SPATIAL PATTERNS AND
ECOLOGICAL INTERACTIONS

Department of Biology

Adviser: Eric Kindahl, Ph.D.

KAYLA RUSSELL

IMPROVING BACULOVIRUS-
BASED PROTEIN PRODUCTION
IN INSECT CELLS

Department of Biology

Adviser: Dominic Esposito, Ph.D.

POSTER PRESENTATIONS
5:30-6:30 P.M.

WHITAKER CAMPUS CENTER, COMMONS

KAYLI HARLING

IMAGINING UTOPIA: LOST IN
LADYLAND

Humanities (M.A.)

Adviser: Adelmar Ramirez, Ph.D.

KELLY ESPOSITO

SAINT HILDEGARD'S NUTMEG
CRACKERS

Humanities (M.A.)

Adviser: Nicole Pulichene, Ph.D.

KISHA MCCRAY

DETERMINANTS OF
SELF-CARE PRACTICES
AMONG BLACK WOMEN
IN HELPING PROFESSIONS:
AN EMPIRICAL STUDY

The George B. Delaplaine Jr. School of
Business

Adviser: Anita Jose, Ph.D.

MARIANA LATORRE

A CONSENSUAL
QUALITATIVE RESEARCH
STUDY: LGBTGEQIAP+
RESILIENCE IN THE FACE OF
MICROAGGRESSIONS

Department of Psychology and
Counseling

Adviser: Amber Samuels, Ph.D.

**MATTHEW CURRAN AND
GRACE FRIZZELL**

SHORTCOMINGS OF POPULAR
AI BENCHMARKS

Department of Computer Science and
Information Technology

Adviser: Jiang Li, Ph.D.

MILLICENT JORDAN

BUILDING TEAM COGNITION
WITH AI

Humanities (M.A.)

Adviser: Adelmar Ramirez, Ph.D.

MITCHEL JACKSON

SUSTAINABLE FOOD
SYSTEMS: TACKLING
UNDERNOURISHMENT
THROUGH ACCESS AND
AFFORDABILITY OF FRUITS
AND VEGETABLES IN
SELECTED COUNTRIES

The George B. Delaplaine Jr. School of
Business

Adviser: Nisha Manikoth, Ph.D.

POSTER PRESENTATIONS

5:30-6:30 P.M.

WHITAKER CAMPUS CENTER, COMMONS

QUIERA HARRIS

AN ETHICAL ANALYSIS OF
THE FEDERAL "RETURN TO
IN-PERSON WORK" MANDATE
THROUGH A DEONTOLOGICAL
LENS: IMPLICATIONS FOR
FEDERAL EMPLOYEES WITH
ADHD

The George B. Delaplaine Jr. School of
Business

Adviser: Karen Hoffman, Ph.D.

RASHIDA KIMBRUE-MAJOR

TOXIC WORKPLACES: ARE
EMPLOYEES LEAVING
BAD BOSSES OR BROKEN
SYSTEMS?

The George B. Delaplaine Jr. School of
Business

Adviser: Nisha Manikoth, Ph.D.

TIA ROSS

ACADEMIC SUCCESS OF
HIGH SCHOOL YOUTH IN THE
JUVENILE LEGAL SYSTEM:
EXAMINING THE IMPACT OF
SCHOOL TRANSITIONS

The George B. Delaplaine Jr. School of
Business

Adviser: Nisha Manikoth, Ph.D.

VENKATA KRISHNA

KANDALAI

APPLICATION OF MACHINE
LEARNING IN HEALTHCARE TO
PREDICT POPULATION AT RISK
OF A HEART ATTACK

Department of Nursing

Adviser: Timothy P. Coffin, Ph.D.

YENLY CAROLINA TELLEZ

EXPLORING DEPRESSION
AMONG FIRST-GENERATION
LATINO IMMIGRANTS IN THE
UNITED STATES

Department of Psychology and
Counseling

Adviser: Amber Samuels, Ph.D.

YANKUO QIAO, PH.D.

CEO CAREER EXPERIENCE AND
INSURANCE INNOVATION IN
CHINA

The George B. Delaplaine Jr. School of
Business

SPIRE SYMPOSIUM: UNDERGRADUATE AND GRADUATE STUDENT ARTWORK

WHITAKER CAMPUS CENTER, WHITAKER ART GALLERY

MIMI BAFOR

B/W ROMAN EMPIRE

TONAL BLACK AND WHITE
CHARCOAL DRAWING

Department of Art and Archaeology
Adviser: Jacob Muldowney

SABELLA BARRON

CHILDHOOD FRIENDS

THROUGH THE EYES OF THE
BEHOLDER

Department of Art and Archaeology
Adviser: Jacob Muldowney

**MACKENZIE BENTLEY,
ALYSSA BREWER, ECLIPSE
CHARBONNEAU, SOPHIA
EWING, ZOE KEAN, JANIAH
ORCHARD, DIEGO SCULLY
RIVERO AND JENNY
SCHLOSSBERG**

DESCRIBING AND
INTERPRETING FORM: ARTS
123

Department of Art and Archaeology
Adviser: Jacob Muldowney

**ALYSSA BREWER, KAREN
HOFFMAN, JASON JOHNSON,
SARAH SETIAWAN AND MIA
WATKINS**

DISCOVERING THE
PROCESS OF MULTIPLE
AND EXPERIMENTING WITH
SURFACE DECORATION: ARTS
343

Department of Art and Archaeology
Adviser: Shin Yeon Jeon

GABBY CARTON

LIGHT OF MY CHILDHOOD

Department of Art and Archaeology
Adviser: Jacob Muldowney

JORDAN DOWLING

STREET SCENE

PORTRAIT

Department of Art and Archaeology
Adviser: Jacob Muldowney

ROBIN DRAETTA

FIGURE IN CONTEXT DRAWING
TWIN CLOWNS

PSYCHOTIC WOMEN

Department of Art and Archaeology
Adviser: Jacob Muldowney

ANNE HUDSON

BUGS

SELF PORTRAIT

STILL LIFE

Department of Art and Archaeology

Adviser: Jacob Muldowney

JOHN KNIGHT

50/50

FALL

Department of Art and Archaeology

Adviser: Andrea McCluskey

BEN LUCARELLOPUMPKINS ARE GOURDS ARE
SQUASH

STOP PEEPING

TRADITIONS

Department of Art and Archaeology

Adviser: Jacob Muldowney

ISABEL MALAGA MATEO

2025 VISION BOARD

LOTUS

HISTORY REPEATS ITSELF, IF
WE DON'T LEARN FROM IT

Department of Art and Archaeology

Advisers: Christina McCleary and
Jacob Muldowney**RYAN MCGLONE**

PLAYING WITH FIRE

Department of Art and Archaeology

Adviser: Natalia Kormeluk

ALYSSA MURTAUGH

A ROSY TEA SET

Department of Art and Archaeology

Adviser: Shin Yeon Jeon

AMANDA PASTORA

POKÉMON POSTER

Department of Art and Archaeology

Adviser: Jacob Muldowney

MELANIE PERRY

WHAT'S IN YOUR BOX

Department of Art and Archaeology

Adviser: Jacob Muldowney

GREY PHILLIPS

FILLING STATION DOILY

Department of English and
Communication Arts

Adviser: Elizabeth Knapp, Ph.D.

HANNAH SCHEIBACH

ACTIVE SHOOTER

Department of Art and Archaeology

Adviser: Jacob Muldowney

JENNY SCHLOSSBERG

ASSORTED STILL LIFE

OLD MAN

STATUE IN THOUGHT

Department of Art and Archaeology

Adviser: Jacob Muldowney

TAUREAN WASHINGTON

BE PREZ OR DIE TRYIN'

Humanities (M.A.)

Adviser: Kimberly Morse Jones, Ph.D.

